

FOREIGN FETISH

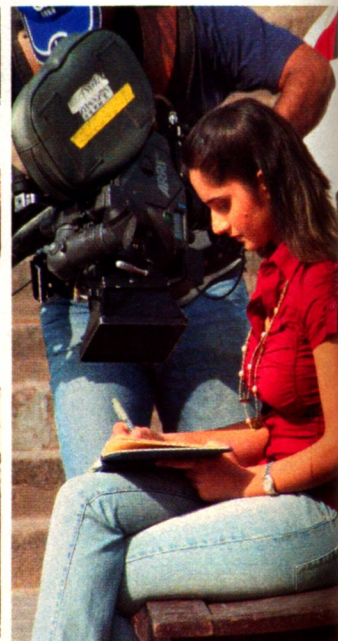
India's obsession with its neighbours continued. **Shoaib Akhtar** (left) was encouraged in his Bollywood dreams, while Jacqueline Fernandes, a Sri Lankan beauty queen, decided to give the desi divas some competition by appearing in ads. Also seen taking Hindi lessons (make that speech lessons for Akhtar) were cricketer Brett Lee and former Saif Ali Khan squeeze Rosa Catalano.



"At one point, there were 3,500 cases against me. I should have been in the *Guinness Book of World Records*."

M.F. HUSAIN, ARTIST

DEEPAK SHARMA



HAIR AND THERE

Sanjaya Malakar (right) captivated Americans with his bad singing and changeable hair on *American Idol* while Shah Rukh Khan's ponytail became a subject of water cooler conversation, Aamir Khan's mini-Mohawk got an alternative name (shark's fin) and

Abhishek Bachchan's (left) long hair (grown for friend Goldie Behl's forever-in-the-making *Drona*) acquired a new fashion accessory: the male hair band.



FOTOCORP



SKIRTING THE FAITH

Katrina Kaif (above left) wore a short skirt to Ajmer Sharif for a movie shoot and **Sania Mirza** shot at Hyderabad's Mecca Masjid with her shoes on. Both offended the traditionalists and both apologised. Public life moved one step back again. As did Kashmiri women in their battle against intolerance when Jammu and Kashmir Deputy Chief Minister Muzaffar Baig decided they could no longer perform outside the state on Republic Day. Somebody please put these people in a time machine.